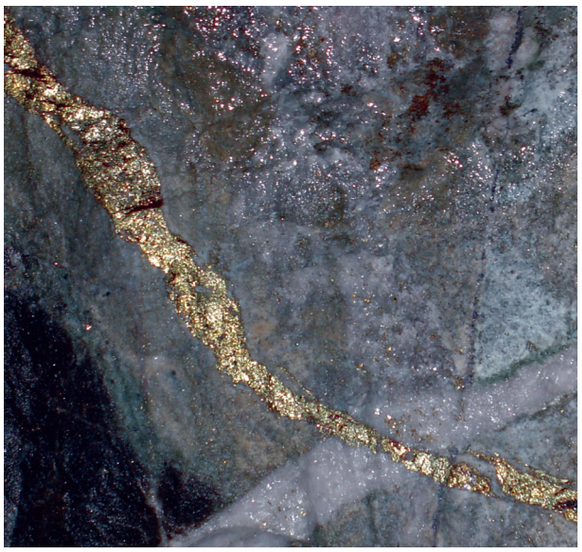


Gold veins

2. Beds or Layers

Minerals that are formed as a result of deposition, accumulation and concentration generally occur in horizontal layers. E.g. Coal, Potash, etc.



Coal



Bauxite

Residual mass of weathered particles

When the decomposed rocks are washed away by water, the soluble particles are removed, leaving a mass containing ores. Such occurrences are called **residual mass.** E.g. Bauxite

3. Alluvial deposits

These are the deposits found in the sands of valley floor and at the foot hills. These deposits consist of the minerals such as Gold, Silver and Platinum.



Platinum

3.4 The world distribution of minerals

Metallic Minerals

The minerals which contain metal in them are called as metallic minerals.

Iron - Ore

It is the basic mineral and the backbone of industrial development of the world. Iron Ore is the most widely distributed element of the earth's crust and it rarely occurs in a free state. It is found as the composition of many rocks and minerals. Iron-ore makes up 4.6% of the earth crusts. Iron is found in the form of Iron - ore. They are classified into 4 categories.

(i) **Magnetite**: It is red in colour and has 72% of pure Iron

(ii) **Hematite:** It is black in colour and has 70% of pure Iron

(iii) **Limonite:** Its colour varies from dark brown to yellow and has 50% of pure iron.

(iv) **Siderite:** It is brown in colour and contains only 30% of pure iron is present.

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